



Some Tips on How to Use Open Source Technology for a Successful Business

While adopting OSS software makes a lot of sense for both start-ups and enterprises, firms are warned to tread with caution. Choosing the right business model and working around the various types of licences, are some challenging parts of the OSS journey.

Today, it would be hard to find software companies refraining from using open source technology. OSS has grown and evolved to a stage where it is almost omnipresent. Even tech start-ups in India are venturing into the market with open source-based solutions. **Diksha P Gupta** from **OpenSource For You** spoke to several established firms that are doing business using open source technology and compiled some tips based on their experiences in the industry. Read on:

Keep constant track of the latest technologies

Technology changes rapidly and when it comes to open source, it changes even more rapidly. OSS software is supported by communities across the globe, which ensures that it changes at a much faster pace than proprietary software. So awareness is the key to sustain oneself in this market. Raj Mathur, founder

of Kandalaya, a consulting firm in the GNU/Linux, network application integration and network security domains, highlights the importance of keeping abreast of all the latest developments. Mathur says, "You should be aware of what technologies are available in different fields even if you are not very conversant with them. Those whose job is basically to architect and implement solutions for their clients, should be aware of the latest and emerging technologies. For instance, when you are architecting a solution in the proprietary software domain for a mail server, you would use one base technology and all the other technologies come along with it. But when you are dealing with open source technology, you have to choose each component individually and make all the components work together. You should be aware of what components are available, as well as their strengths, weaknesses and special features. You should also